



Strategy by Design (SxD)

A framework by John Anders Grøtting and Lomi Agency

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Market Leadership is a balancing act between Strategy (wanting long-term impact) and Execution (focused on immediate needs).

Few companies can bridge that gap and 60-90% of strategies fail to achieve their intended results*.

Key Pains Uncovered From Interviews

1. Ignored Strategy

1.1 Strategy translates poorly into actionable tasks

- Employees struggle to relate day-to-day work to overarching strategy.
- Lack of vertical alignment.

1.2 Making strategy understood

- Strategy confusing or not relatable.
- Can't engage team or they can't remember all of the points.
- Disagree with strategy.

1.3 Internal resistance

- Not created here mentality.
- Top-down strategy dictation means disconnect with implementation reality.

1.4 Need for strategic thinking at all levels

- Employees focus on immediate tasks rather than strategic priorities.
- Insights gained at front-line not passed upwards.
- Strategic thinking is often seen as an executive responsibility rather than an organizational capability.

1.5 Strategy can't adapt to changing needs

- Growth dilutes the agility and innovation of a startup mindset.
- Keeping an adaptive, fast-moving culture while increasing structure and process.

2. Imbalanced Pipeline

2.1 Lack of prioritization best practices

- No common frameworks to balance long-term strategic initiatives with short-term operational work.
- Strategic initiatives often get deprioritized in favor of urgent tasks.

2.2 Discouraging strategic work

- Teams are penalized for missing short-term goals, creating resistance to working on long-term strategic initiatives.
- Performance metrics often reward immediate results over sustained impact.

2.3 Difficulty in stopping non-viable initiatives

- Organizations struggle to discontinue projects, even after significant investment.

2.4 Measuring strategic progress

- Lack of effective frameworks to track strategic initiatives.
- Difficulty in translating high-level business targets into actionable team goals.

3. Siloed Organization

3.1 Organizational silos hinder strategy implementation

- Different departments interpret strategy differently, leading to misalignment.
- Conflicting priorities emerge as organizations grow.

3.2 Cross-functional and Cross-team Coordination

- Lack of structured processes for cross-team collaboration.

3.3 Inefficient resource management

- Chronic shortages of people lead to strategic initiatives being deprioritized.
- A more fluid approach to resource management could dynamically shift people to balance capabilities.

3.4 Knowledge is buried in silos

- Customer insights and product plans are not shared effectively across teams.
- This results in duplicate research, redundant development efforts, and wasted resources.

ANALYSIS

Strategy Fails When It's Created in Isolation

Executives create strategy without engaging those who execute it. Assumptions about customer needs and feasibility go unvalidated. This leads to misalignment, wasted effort, and failed execution.

We ensure Strategy and Execution continuously shape each other through real-world feedback—so strategy stays relevant, and execution stays aligned.

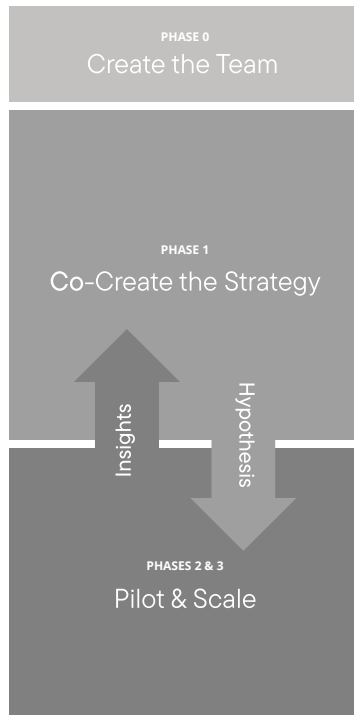


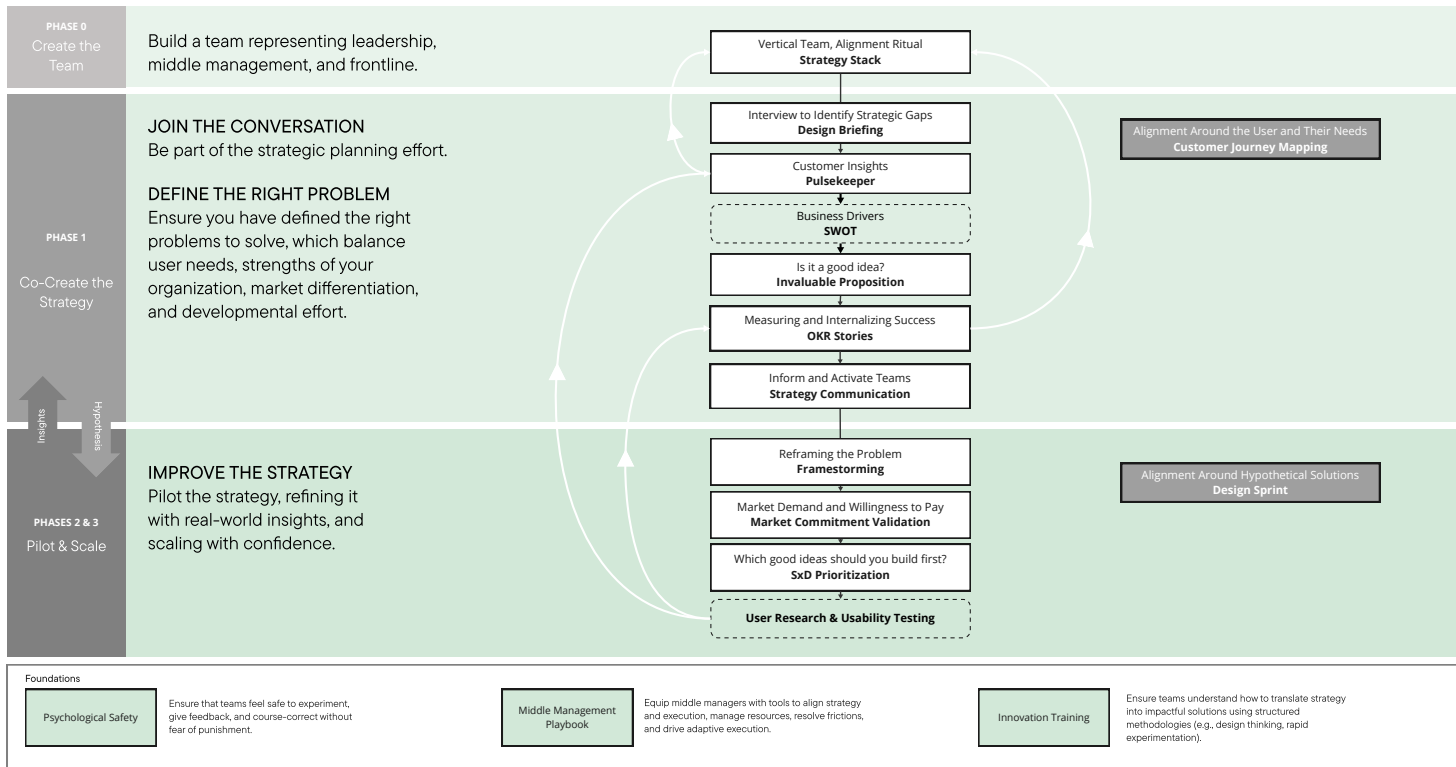
The Strategy Execution Gap

The Strategy by Design (SxD) Framework bridges the Strategy Execution Gap by ensuring strategy flows seamlessly into execution—cutting through rigid structures and siloed thinking.

We apply design principles in three key ways:

- **Deep User Insights** – Identifying the most relevant challenges when defining strategy.
- **Iterative Prototyping** – Testing strategic initiatives in controlled pilots before full-scale rollout.
- **Holistic Co-Creation** – Treating the organization as a connected system, so strategy flows seamlessly into action.





The Buy-In Pathway

How influence begins. How strategy takes root.

A Vertical Team

Phase 1: Get Invited to the Dance

You can't lead if you're not in the room.

You see something broken. A roadmap that doesn't match reality. A goal that doesn't serve the user. But if you challenge it head-on, you get shut out.

Instead, you offer to help—in a way that fits your roles. You run a Design Briefing. Or a Risk Framing Session. Or a Rapid Insight Review. It sounds like support, but it opens the door to better thinking.

Tools: Role-based entry points (Design Briefing, Opportunity Framing, Insight Capture)
Goal: Be seen as helpful. Gain access. Surface better questions.

Phase 3: Create Shared Commitment

Now you build momentum—together.

Trust turns into permission to act.
You bring multiple roles into the same room. You surface assumptions. You test quickly. You create a safe place for cross-functional clarity—and real progress.

Tools: Design Sprint, Field Research, Prioritization, OKR Stories
Goal: Facilitate alignment. Reduce risk. Generate visible value.

Phase 2: Prove Your Value (Quietly)

People start trusting your judgment.

You're no longer fighting to be heard. Now you're helping the team clarify direction. You run a workshop. You connect the dots. You ask the question that unlocks alignment.

You don't take credit. You don't challenge leadership. You let others own the insight and they ask you back next time.

Tools: Value Proposition Workshop, Journey Mapping, Field Research
Goal: Help others succeed. Show you're worth listening to.

Phase 4: Maintain Strategic Integrity

Strategy dies without rhythm. You keep it alive.

You've helped the team learn something real. But systems drift. Priorities shift. This phase is about building habits, rituals, and structures to protect clarity and focus.

You run regular check-ins. You surface insight patterns. You help teams reflect and adapt before they spiral back into noise.

Tools: Strategic OKRs, Pulsekeeper, Communication Rituals
Goal: Embed reflection. Protect focus. Scale your impact.

Before innovation systems can work, people need to believe in them.

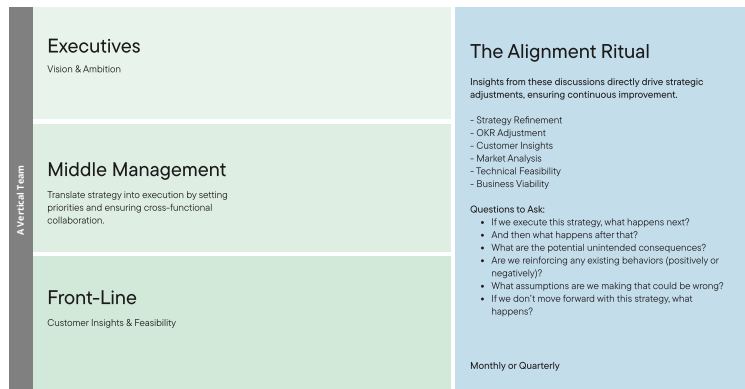
Before strategy can align with execution, someone needs to earn the right to shape it.

The Buy-In Pathway is a four-phase journey that helps leaders, designers, product managers, and change agents build trust, prove value, and quietly reshape how decisions get made.

It's not about forcing change.
It's about earning influence—step by step.

The Strategy Stack

Alignment for Execution & Adpatability



The Strategy Stack is a core element of the Strategy by Design (SxD) Framework, ensuring that strategy is not created in isolation but developed, refined, and executed through a cross-functional, multi-tiered approach.

Why the Strategy Stack Matters

- **Breaks Down Silos** – Strategy is co-created, validated, and continuously refined at all levels.
- **Ensures Strategic Clarity** – Teams understand not just the 'what' but also the 'why' behind decisions.
- **Increases Execution Feasibility** – Real-world insights make strategies actionable and sustainable.
- **Adapts to Change** – The structured feedback and iteration process enables organizations to dynamically adjust strategy as markets, technologies, and regulations evolve.
- **Fosters Ownership & Commitment** – A culture of participation leads to stronger buy-in and accountability.

The Strategy Stack transforms strategy into a living process, keeping organizations aligned, agile, and ready to evolve in a rapidly changing environment.

Pulsekeeper

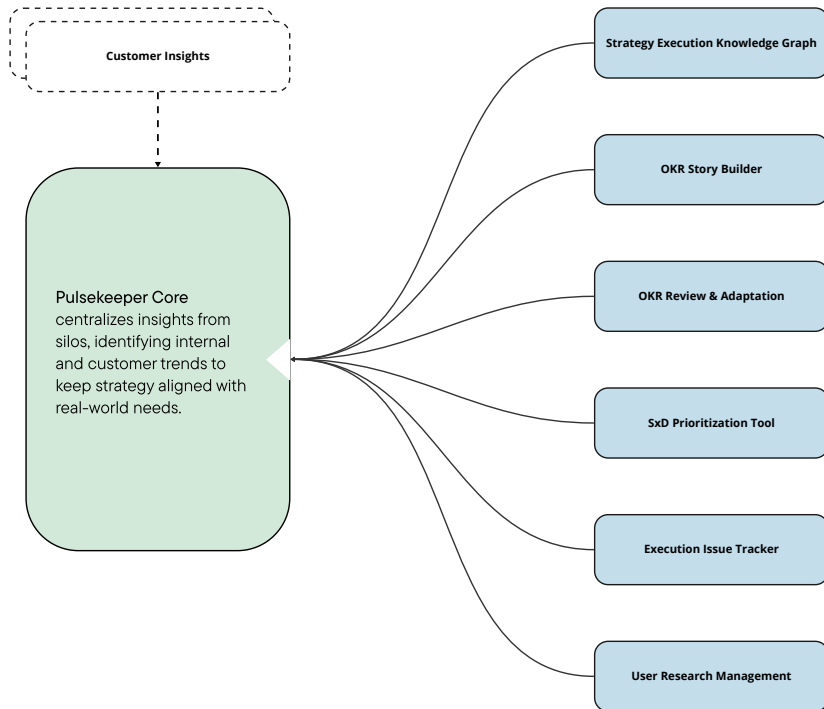
If Only Your Company Knew What It Knows

Core Features of Pulsekeeper

- **AI-Driven Knowledge Graph** – Connects strategy insights, execution data, and user research.
- **User Research Integration** – Aggregates feedback from surveys, interviews, and analytics.
- **Automated Summarization** – Extracts key themes and insights from research.
- **Trend Tracking & Issue Reporting** – Detects execution misalignments and emerging trends.
- **Real-Time Execution Monitoring** – Tracks OKRs, initiatives, and strategy progress.
- **Cross-Team Alignment Dashboard** – Ensures vertical and horizontal alignment.
- **Automated Reporting & Insights** – Generates summaries and strategic recommendations.

Pulsekeeper Plug-Ins

- **Strategy Execution Knowledge Graph** – Maps relationships between OKRs, execution data, and research insights.
- **OKR Story Builder** – Guides teams in crafting structured, narrative-driven OKRs.
- **OKR Evolution & Execution Insights** – Continuously reviews and adapts OKRs based on real-time data.
- **SxD Adaptive Prioritization Engine** – Helps teams prioritize initiatives based on impact and feasibility.
- **Execution Issue Tracker** – Captures and escalates execution roadblocks for faster resolution.
- **User Research Management** – Centralizes and organizes user insights to inform strategy decisions.



Invaluable Proposition Methodology

The best margins and growth opportunities depend on creating unmatched value that makes customers choose you over alternatives—not just once, but repeatedly.

APPLICABLE TO

- Overarching company strategy
- Group strategy
- Product Strategy

1. Unmet Needs

What unmet need can you find?

Prioritize 3-5 attributes

Focus on the deepest motivations, not just surface preferences.

Example: Instead of "convenience", choose "control over choices".

2. Strengths

What are your strengths?

Prioritize 3-5 attributes

Pick only the most truly unique capabilities.

Example: Instead of "AI-driven", go for "AI that predicts future user needs before they arise".

3. Positioning

What positioning can you own?

Prioritize 3-5 attributes

Identify the clearest white space in the industry.

Example: Instead of "affordable", refine it to "affordable but premium-feeling experience".

4. Proposition

Formulate a proposition. Ask critical questions.

Synthesis

Define a proposition that addresses:

- unmet needs
- your strengths
- unique positioning

5. Be critical

Ask critical questions.

Answer the questions:

- If we introduce this proposition, how will customer behavior change over time?
- What secondary effects might occur in the market?
- Could this strategy reinforce or disrupt existing industry trends?
- If we succeed, what new challenges will arise?

OPTION A

Hypothesis-based Approach

Hypothetical Customer Needs
Internal cross-functional team formulates Hypothetical customer needs: Product, Management, Engineering, Design, Sales, Support.

Hypothetical SWOT
Leadership and team formulate opinion on SWOT, based on their own perception.

Hypothetical Positioning
Leadership and team guesses where the company stands in the market.

Hypothetical Proposition
Pick one attribute from each column and draft simple proposition statements. Iterate until team feels one is the strongest.

The Invaluable Test:

1. Does it solve a deep customer problem?
2. Does it leverage our unique strengths?
3. Does it differentiate us in the market?

“ Proposition Template
For [target audience]
the [brand/product]
is the only [segment within a category]
that [solves key pain OR delivers key value]
by leveraging [unique strength OR differentiation]. ”

OPTION B

Evidence-based Approach

Measurable Customer Needs.
Field research used to discover customer needs.
Model Customer Needs
Formulate an evidence based hypothesis of needs

Evidence-based SWOT
Competitive Analysis and Internal Performance
Data derives benchmark of competitive advantages

Evidence-based Positioning
Analysis of customer perception and competitor differentiation. This requires interviews and structured mapping of competition

Evidence-based Proposition
Create 3-5 hypothetical propositions and create prototypes, which are then tested with customers. Iterate until strong response from customers.

ENHANCEMENTS

First Principles
Deconstruct needs to root causes.
Jobs Tree
Visualize goal hierarchy.

First Principles
Deconstruct whether each strength is truly unique.

Opportunity Mapping
Assess gaps versus strengths to find true white space.

Frameworking
Refine multiple versions of the proposition to maximize differentiation and uniqueness

Examples:
For biotech researchers,
the GenXplorer platform
is the only AI-driven discovery tool
that accelerates new drug formulations by 40%
by leveraging the world's largest proprietary dataset of molecular interactions.

“ For ultra-high-net-worth travelers,
the Aurum Private Concierge
is the only luxury travel service
that guarantees exclusive, once-in-a-lifetime experiences
by leveraging a global network of high-profile insiders and elite concierge specialists. ”

OKR Stories

High-impact teams understand why their work matters.
They create a shared narrative to internalize success metrics.

1. Define Narrative

What could the user's future look like?

Develop 3-5 alternatives

2. Iterate & Validate

Test and refine your narrative.

1 final narrative

3. Translate to OKRs

How can you measure success?

Maximum 3 Objectives and 5 Key Results

4. Solutioning

Brainstorm solutions. Ask critical Questions.

Create a list of solutions for your backlog

5. Be critical

Ask critical Questions.

Questions to Ask:

- What is the smallest change that would have the biggest impact?
- Are we solving the root problem or just a symptom?
- If we could only improve one thing, what would it be?
- Where are we overcomplicating things? Can we simplify?

OPTION A

Hypothesis-based Approach

Brainstorm Needs
Internal cross-functional team formulates Hypothetical customer needs: Product Management, Engineering, Design, Sales, Support.

Formulate subjective Product Narratives
Formulate a narrative based on team hypothesis

Internal feedback
Leadership and team formulate opinion on Narratives, based on their own perception.

Finalize narrative
Based on team feedback create a singular narrative.

OKRs developed by an individual
A manager or other person defines OKRs and explains them to the team.

Solutions developed by an individual
A manager or other person defines solutions, based upon the Key Results and explains them to the team. There are then put into the backlog.

OPTION B

Evidence-based Approach

Research Customer Needs
Field research used to discover product-specific customer needs.

Formulate objective Product Narratives
Formulate an evidence-based hypothesis of needs.

Validate with customers
Interview customers to see how well the alternatives reflect their key pains and provide useful solutions.

Finalize narrative
Use customer feedback to create a singular narrative.

OKRs developed by the team
The team that will be using the OKRs develop their OKRs together with their manager.

Solutions developed by the team
The team brainstorms solutions, based upon the Key Results and explains them to the team. There are then put into the backlog.

ENHANCEMENTS

Prototype
Create a quick visualization of alternative approach to the narrative

User Interviews
Test prototypes with customers to see if the story mirrors their issues and provides solutions that resonate.

Narrative as film
Create a film to bring the narrative to life. This can be a voiceover of a slideshow, animation, or even live action.

OKR Validation
Conduct User interviews or usability tests with customers for product or service-related objectives

Prioritization
Usually a team will generate more solutions than they have the resources to complete. We provide a framework for various approaches to prioritization. Please refer to that.

Product Narrative Example



1 Customer Character
Have a mother of two teenagers and consultant with various clients. She tends to work longer days than the demands of her customers. Her husband is traveling every other week, so she has an extra burden at home. Her teenage daughter has indicated her to be much more environmentally-conscious.



2 Value Proposition (deposition)
Make sustainable decisions enjoyable and carefree for everyone (not just hardcore environmentalists) in everyday situations.



2a Insight (deposition)
As much as Maria would like to only have sustainable daily goods, she simply doesn't have the extra time that it would need to visit stores and make her own cleaning products. Also, her experience with sustainable cleaning products is that they don't clean as well as the ones she likes and the price is too expensive.



3a How It Works (Photo)
The LoveLife shop provides a broad selection from LoveLife and partners of sustainable products to cover all cleaning needs. They are an effective at cleaning and meant to complement aesthetics in a on-to-offer circular packaging solution that self-manages inventory.

Effective cleaning Pleasant odor Time saving

3b Problem Definition (Conflict)
Now needs a sustainable cleaning product, which is very effective at cleaning, smells pleasant, safe, and which doesn't require her to make an extra effort to get.

3c Context and Tone (Setting)
The competition focus on the extremes. Either they optimize to be highly effective cleaning products with pleasant sales OR they are very sustainable. The highly effective products have the larger market share. Our opportunity is to be effective enough and be highly sustainable. We may not be as optimized as either of those categories, but we feel we have a good balance to fit into the lives of a large audience.



4a Context and Tone (Setting)
If your product into a competitive map. Draw a diagram with four quadrants that lets you position your idea apart from competitive solutions. To create the quadrants, name the east-west axis based on one attribute (low to the left, high to the right) and name the north-south axis on another (low at the bottom, high at the top). Place one of other options your customers have for solving the problem you are to solve (alternative solutions and competitive products) and place them on the grid. Your idea should sit in the upper right-hand corner (the high-high quadrant). Hopefully you're alone in your quadrant or share it with very few competitors. -- Just like the guy at Beecher Report.

Explanation

1 Customer Character
Think of the ideal type of customer for your product and make a note of it on your storyboard under the customer box. This should be the person that would find your product most compelling. In the case of Air New Zealand, it was parents (of small children) who travel on long haul flights. Other people might have enjoyed their SkyCoach innovation, but their best customer was clearly parents with little kids going a long ways.

2 Insights (Motivation)
Identify insights that portray what your ideal customer faces. Summarize them on your storyboard under the insight box. Functional insights are good, but also use "You can discover an insight that is particularly emotional or social. In the Wallace example, Michelle Croxley understood that divorce was an alien experience for most people and that the steps were complex and confusing. But most importantly, she identified the potential rewards of a continuous process on the extended family, especially children. That was the more emotional insight. You can also think of this box as describing the customers that your customers wish to achieve. Fast resolution of divorce proceedings is a functional outcome, emotional comfort and reasonable interpersonal dynamics might be a desired emotional outcome.

3 Problem Definition (Conflict)
Draft the problem definition for your narrative and put it below the conflict box on your storyboard. As you learn all of the innovation capabilities in this course, you'll see that we like to use the phrase "how might we" to tie up the problem statement. We use this language to articulate the problem that your product exists to solve. In the Google Adwords example, the statement might have been, "how might we create an extremely efficient way for advertisers to find - and engage with - the most likely customer for their product?" For Weivance, the statement might have been, "how might we minimize the emotional impact of divorce on children?" As you develop your strategy, you may decide to make this question more (or less) specific, so feel free to modify the storyboard as you go.

4 Value Proposition (deposition)
Try to articulate the value proposition for your product. Don't write down how works or what it does, rather state what it does for the user, what benefits it provides. As you learn more about understanding customers in Modules 3 and 4, you'll be able to fine-tune your value proposition. For now, write what you think is a user-based #4 on your storyboard.

5 How It Works (Photo)
Explain your product by boiling it down to three points that convey how it works.

6 Context and Tone (Setting)
If your product into a competitive map. Draw a diagram with four quadrants that lets you position your idea apart from competitive solutions. To create the quadrants, name the east-west axis based on one attribute (low to the left, high to the right) and name the north-south axis on another (low at the bottom, high at the top). Place one of other options your customers have for solving the problem you are to solve (alternative solutions and competitive products) and place them on the grid. Your idea should sit in the upper right-hand corner (the high-high quadrant). Hopefully you're alone in your quadrant or share it with very few competitors. -- Just like the guy at Beecher Report.

SxD Prioritization

High-impact teams understand why their work matters.
They create a shared narrative to internalize success metrics.

APPLICABLE TO
- Product Strategy



OPTION A Hypothesis-based Approach

Select one Business Goal (optional two)
Speed to Market
Product Market Fit
Competitive Differentiation
Revenue Growth
Enterprise Stability
Operational Efficiency
User Engagement & Retention
Regulatory Compliance & Risk
Ecosystem Growth

Describe Features
Either write descriptions for features that can be used in a questionnaire. You may be able to get this data from Jira.

Answer Questionnaire Internally
Have a group of diverse, internal people answer the questionnaire. Get at least 10 people to participate.

Answers will be plotted on a Kano Model Diagram.

Senior technical member estimates
Have a senior member of the technical staff assign a value score to each feature.

OPTION B Evidence-based Approach

Stakeholder Interviews
Talk to cross-functional leaders to ensure there is alignment on why this is being done.

Have Customers Answer Questionnaire
Send the questionnaire to at least 10 customers.
Answers will be plotted on a Kano Model Diagram.

Technical team creates estimate
The team that will be doing the development should create the effort estimates, based upon 1-3 point sizes

ENHANCEMENTS

Business Goal Prioritization Workshop
Gather diverse stakeholders and

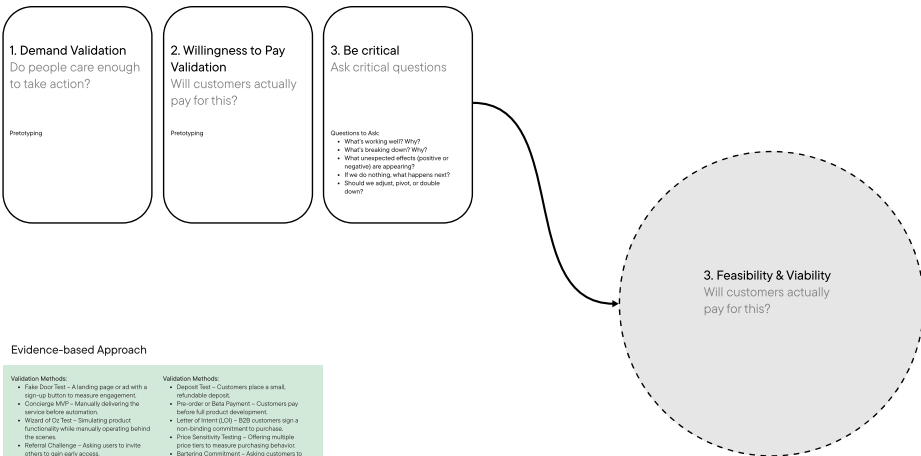
Have Customers Answer Questionnaire
Send the questionnaire to at least 20 customers per customer segment and geography.
Answers will be plotted on a Kano Model Diagram.

Results are automatically calculated

Market Commitment Validation

The Market Commitment Validation (MCV) framework is a structured methodology designed to validate market demand and willingness to pay before investing heavily in product development. It ensures that businesses do not build solutions for non-existent problems or create products that customers are unwilling to pay for. MCV focuses on testing real-world customer behavior, reducing risk, and iterating rapidly to refine the value proposition.

APPLICABLE TO
- Product Strategy



Evidence-based Approach

Validation Methods: • Fake Door Test – A landing page or ad with a sign-up button to measure engagement. • Concierge MVP – Manually delivering the service before automation. • Wizard of Oz Test – Simulating product functionality with manually operating behind the scenes. • Referral Challenge – Asking users to invite others to gain early access. • Behavioral Interviews – Conducting research focused on past behavior rather than hypotheticals.	Validation Methods: • Deposit Test – Customers place a small, refundable deposit. • Pre-order or Beta Payment – Customers pay before full product development. • Letter of Intent (LOI) – B2B customers sign a non-binding commitment to purchase. • Price Sensitivity Testing – Offering multiple price tiers to measure purchasing behavior. • Bartering Commitment – Asking customers to exchange something valuable (e.g., time, referrals, data).
Success Criteria: • 5-10% conversion rate on Fake Door sign-ups. • Users continue engaging with a manual service despite its inefficiencies. • Organic referrals indicate viral potential. • Behavioral interviews confirm alignment between user pain points and the product vision.	Success Criteria: • 5-10% of engaged users pre-pay or place a deposit. • 10-20% of B2B buyers sign an LOI. • Users consistently choose higher-priced tiers in pricing experiments. • Customers trade something valuable, showing a real commitment beyond words.
Actionable Next Steps: • If demand is validated, proceed to Willingness to Pay Validation. • If demand is weak, iterate on positioning, target audience, or feature set. • If demand is nonexistent, consider pausing, merging with another initiative, or killing the project.	Actionable Next Steps: • If willingness to pay is validated, proceed to execution. • If willingness to pay is weak, iterate on pricing models, value proposition, or monetization strategy. • If customers refuse to pay at any price, consider pausing, merging, or discontinuing the project.

Strategy Communication

Effective teams align behind a shared vision, ensuring that strategy becomes actionable and impactful.

APPLICABLE TO
- Product Strategy

1. Create Strategic Awareness

Ensure people recognize the shift is inevitable, and inaction is failure.

Memo, Speech, or Event

2. Frame the Strategic Shift

Give teams clarity of purpose but freedom to explore solutions.

Provide a "before and after" picture, define guiding principles, and set a high-level vision without over-prescribing steps.

3. Empower Teams with Problem Spaces, Not Just Solutions

People resist imposed change but embrace challenges when they have ownership.

Define the challenge, encourage autonomy, and foster cross-functional collaboration.

4. Embed Strategy into Workflows & Decision-Making

A strategy isn't real until it influences daily work.

Modify decision frameworks, align KPIs, and ensure leaders reinforce strategy in daily operations.

5. Reinforce Adoption with Rapid Wins & Feedback Loops

Momentum builds buy-in—early wins matter.

Establish short-term milestones, celebrate progress, and iterate based on feedback.

6. Maintain Strategic Narrative & Iterative Alignment

Keep repeating, refining, and reinforcing the strategy—it's an ongoing process.

Hold quarterly alignment sessions, maintain open communication, and continually refresh the strategic message.

Psychological Safety

Successful strategy execution relies on open dialogue, honest feedback, and the ability to challenge assumptions—all of which require psychological safety. Without it, teams hesitate to surface risks, misalignment goes unaddressed, and execution suffers.

How Psychological Safety Supports SxD

1. **Encourages Open Feedback Loops** – Teams at all levels feel safe to question strategic decisions, ensuring realignment when execution realities differ from leadership intent.
2. **Enables Adaptive Execution** – Teams can experiment, iterate, and adjust strategy based on customer insights and market changes without fear of blame.
3. **Strengthens Cross-Tier Collaboration** – Psychological safety fosters trust between executives, middle management, and front-line teams, allowing strategy to be refined collaboratively rather than dictated top-down.
4. **Prevents Hidden Risks & Bottlenecks** – When teams feel safe to raise concerns, execution challenges can be identified early and addressed proactively.
5. **Drives Commitment & Accountability** – A culture of trust increases engagement, ensuring individuals take ownership of both successes and failures.

Our Role in Psychological Safety

While Strategy by Design (SxD) depends on psychological safety, it is typically coached and facilitated by external partners. Our framework integrates with these efforts by ensuring that strategy processes support transparency, inclusivity, and collaborative decision-making.

The Middle Management Playbook

Middle management bridges strategy and execution, ensuring alignment, momentum, and operational success. Positioned between executives and front-line teams, they translate high-level vision into clear objectives while maintaining agility in execution. This playbook provides structured methods to enable middle managers to drive alignment, resolve bottlenecks, and foster a culture of collaboration and accountability.

Core Responsibilities

- **Strategic Translation:** Turn vision into actionable goals and ensure clarity.
- **Alignment & Integration:** Prevent silos, drive **Alignment Rituals**, and relay insights.
- **Execution Oversight:**
 - Monitor progress, resolve blockers, and allocate resources.
 - Encourage managers to ask: *What happens next if we implement this decision?* What are the potential unintended consequences?
- **Empowering Teams:** Foster autonomy, psychological safety, and strategic thinking.

The Middle Management Framework

- **Clarify & Communicate:** Use storytelling, align teams, and define execution-ready OKRs.
- **Facilitate Alignment:**
 - Run **Alignment Rituals**, OKR workshops, and cross-functional syncs.
 - Use **Strategy Pulse Check** questions in OKR workshops to ensure execution remains adaptive. Sample question: *What's working? What's breaking? Should we adjust, pivot, or double down?*
- **Monitor & Adapt:**
 - Apply **Feedback Loops**, track KPIs, and resolve blockers in real time.
 - Identify and act on the smallest, highest-leverage changes to improve execution.
- **Develop Talent & Culture:** Promote leadership growth and cross-functional collaboration.

Key Practices

- **Avoid Micromanagement:** Guide teams while enabling autonomy.
- **Use Data & Insights:** Validate progress with real-time feedback.
- **Ensure Psychological Safety:** Encourage experimentation.
- **Run Checkpoints:** Balance execution with long-term vision.
- **Align Resources:** Prioritize strategic initiatives.
- **Foster Collaboration:** Use shared OKRs and sync meetings.

By following these principles, middle managers ensure adaptable and effective strategy execution.

Innovation Training

Innovation Training helps middle managers and all Strategy Stack participants drive execution by embedding structured innovation into daily work. It bridges strategy and execution, fostering creativity, experimentation, and collaboration through Strategic Design and rapid iteration.

Core Objectives

- **Integrate Innovation into Execution:** Ensure alignment with business goals.
- **Enhance Problem-Solving:** Use **Strategic Design** to reframe challenges.
- **Promote Experimentation:** Encourage safe risk-taking and iteration.
- **Strengthen Collaboration:** Break silos through teamwork and shared goals.

Key Training Elements

- **Strategic Design & Problem Framing:**
 - Reframe challenges and identify opportunities.
 - Encourage teams to consider *not just the direct impact of an innovation, but also second- and third-order effects.*
- **Rapid Experimentation & Prototyping:**
 - Test ideas quickly before scaling.
 - Encourage teams to focus on the **smallest possible experiment** that validates a big idea.
- **Innovation Workshops:** Facilitate ideation and cross-team collaboration.
- **Psychological Safety & Risk-Taking:** Foster an experimental mindset.
- **Innovation Metrics & Feedback Loops:**
 - Measure impact and refine execution.
 - Use **Strategy Pulse Check** to assess whether innovations are **delivering real value**. Sample question: *What unexpected behaviors are emerging? Are we reinforcing the right outcomes?*

Implementation Strategies

1. **Embed Training into Leadership Programs:** Train all **Strategy Stack** participants.
2. **Establish Innovation Rituals:** Use workshops, hackathons, and brainstorming.
3. **Provide Coaching & Support:** Offer expert guidance and case studies.
4. **Align Innovation with Strategy:** Use **Strategic Design** to keep innovation focused.

Why This Matters

Innovation isn't just ideation—it's turning ideas into execution. Training teams in Strategic Design, experimentation, and collaboration builds sustainable innovation aligned with business goals.

By embedding Innovation Training, organizations empower teams to drive meaningful change and ensure execution stays adaptable and forward-thinking.

Thank you for your interest

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Attribution & Use

This document presents the Strategy by Design (SxD) Framework, developed by John Anders Grotting and Lomi Agency.

It is currently a work in progress, and we welcome feedback and discussion.
If you would like to reference or share this content, please contact us first.

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